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ISDRA

ISDRA Officials Handbook

OFFICIAL IDENTIFICATION

Officials should wear some form of identification. Easy identification is a convenience to other officials, contestants and spectators. On the trail drivers can then immediately distinguish between officials and spectators. The ISDRA Driver Report Form for sanctioned races asks if officials could be easily identified.

Identification should be of a highly visible color such as bright orange with lettering in a strongly contrasting color such as black.

Types of official identification vary. Armbands of felt fastened with safety pins are common. They have the titles of major officials written out and the others saying only "official".

Bibs (like a racer's number) or vests are easier to distinguish from a distance. They can have the titles of major officials written out and the other saying only "official", or they can use just initials for every official. Examples: R.M. - Race Marshall; TB - Trail Boss; CT - Chief Timer; C- Checker; S- Steward, etc.

No matter what form of identification officials are wearing, drivers should be informed of the method in advance of the race. This can be conveniently accomplished at the driver's meeting.

RACE MARSHALL/CHIEF JUDGE

An explanation of the terminology used in the positions of "Race Marshall" and "Chief Judge": in some areas of sled dog racing, the title of Race Marshall is used to designate the position of top authority by the race sponsoring organization. In many other areas, the term Chief Judge is used to designate the same position. In order to facilitate the use of this guide by all areas of the sport, the editors have used the combined term Race Marshall/Chief Judge to designate this position. It is intended that the title "Race Marshall/Chief Judge" indicate that person who is primarily in charge of all other officials and workers involved in the functioning of the event. This person is always responsible to the race sponsoring organization. In several of the larger events, the positions of Race Marshall and Chief Judge are separate and distinct as provided by the race sponsoring organization. In most such cases, the position of Race Marshall is the ultimate authority during the course of a race.

It should be understood that this handbook is intended as a general guide subject to whatever modifications are necessary to successfully meet the requirements of the sponsoring organization, the competitors in the event and the spectators that view the event.

* * * * *

(The Race Marshall, in some events, has been called the Race Chairman or Race Manager.)

- The Race Marshall/Chief Judge is the person in COMPLETE CHARGE of the race itself and determines infractions of and enforces the rules.
- Some race giving organizations have given the title Race Marshall. Chief Judge to figurehead celebrities. ISDRA suggests that to avoid confusion, such a person be given the title "Honorary Race Marshall" or "Honorary Chief Judge"

QUALIFICATIONS

- Must be a person of unquestioned integrity, reliability and have the courage of his convictions.
- Must have thorough knowledge of the rules. (See Race Manual, Sec. EE, FF)
- Preferably have race experience.

EQUIPMENT

- The officials' table is headquarters.
- Copies of job descriptions for: assistant judges, sled holders, club handlers, and veterinarian. (Request from Race Committee secretary) See organization chart and job descriptions, this handbook.

- Copies of Race Rules and Explanations for any drivers or officials who request them. (Request from Race Committee secretary)

CHAIN OF COMMAND

- The Race Marshall/Chief Judge is selected by the race giving organization in whatever way it sees fit. He reports only to it.
- If the race giving organization puts on a series of races, the Race Marshall/Chief Judge generally holds office for the entire season.
- The President or Chairman of the race giving organization may also be the Race Marshall/Chief Judge, or he may act as Race Marshall/Chief Judge in the extraordinary case that the latter is absent.

DUTIES

- Be responsible for the entire race from planning the physical layout through the running of the race and the writing up of final reports.
- Be available for consultation during all phases of the planning of the race. Any questionable areas should have your personal approval.
- Appoint, or approve of, the key officials who report to you.
- Know who all officials are (See Organization Chart, this handbook)
- Before, during and after the race, keep tabs on all officials to see that they are functioning. Do this personally or through reports from other designated officials.
- If some job is not being done or if an area is lacking personnel, it is your responsibility to correct the situation.
- Obtain assistance of local or state police as necessary. Tell them where to direct traffic.
- Schedule time for the different classes and events to take place. (See Race manual, Section Y)
- Approve positions of Trail Checkers and Stewards. Authorize the Trail Judge to give specific instructions to Stewards. (See Race Manual EE-3, FF-5, Rule III D 1)
- Appoint someone to hand out: Official's Identification, Driver's Numbers (See Race Manual EE-2, Rule Id5), Mushers' and Handlers' Armbands.
- Obtain services of a veterinarian.
- Appoint and give job descriptions to assistant judge, Sled Holders, and Club Handlers.
- Investigate reports of irregularities coming in from Dog Marking and Inspection Judges.
- Request the veterinarian to examine any dog whose fitness to run is questionable.

Be in charge of the starting line.

- Reduce the size of any or all teams if warranted.
- Remove any dog from a team if unfit to run (get advice of veterinarian)

- Refuse permission for a team to start for just cause.
 - Example: not enough dogs in a team, late arrival, or driver unfit.

Be in charge of the finish line.

- Direct sled handlers or other assistants to keep finish line and area between finish line and trucks clear of spectators.
- Request veterinarian to examine any dogs brought back in the sled.
- Be available for consultation in the vicinity of the holding area and starting chute throughout the race.
- Pick out dogs for drug testing if necessary. (See Race Manual, Sec. KK)
- Cope with any emergency, which may arise.

CHAIR ALL MEETINGS

- The drawing. (See Race Manual, EE-2, FF-3, Rule II A)
- Any Officials meetings.
- Drivers meetings. (See Race Manual N-1)
- Protest Committee Meeting

POWERS

- Refuse entries for just cause.(See Race Manual EE-1, FF-1, Rule I B 1)
- Postpone or cancel the race for such cause as bad weather conditions, or trail problems beyond the control of race giving organization. (See Race manual, section ZZ)
- Make requests of the spectators either individually or as a group.
- Be the only person who can disqualify a team. (See Race Manual, EE-4, Rule VI B 1)
- Can immediately disqualify a team for just cause before it leaves the starting line.
 - Example: drunk driver
- Can immediately disqualify a team for just cause as it crosses the finish line.
 - Example: Driver comes in and immediately starts to abuse his dogs.
- Be the person to authorize the change of driver. (See Race Manual, EE-1, Rule I B 8 a)

DRIVER PROTESTS

- Receive, investigate and act upon all protests.
- Advise all concerned parties if a protest meeting should be called.

- Have the final say on any matter, based upon the framework of the race and within the limits of the race rules. No appeal of your decisions is provided for. (See Race Manual EE-4, FF-7, Rule IV B)

DISQUALIFICATION OR WARNINGS

- Advise concerned parties if any are indicated before, during or after the race.
- A protest meeting need not be held to determine the disqualification of a team.
- In obvious cases, the disqualification can be immediate.
- If the Race Committee Chairman has decided to test for drugs, provide the veterinarian with a copy of Race Manual Section KK, ISDRA Drug Control Procedure.

RACE MARSHALL'S/CHIEF JUDGE RUNNER

This person runs errands for the Race Marshall/Chief Judge.

QUALIFICATIONS

- Must be available to the Race Marshall/Chief Judge through out the course of the race
- Must be responsible and able to complete a mission without being distracted.
- Must be familiar with mushers and officials and the physical layout of the starting area.
- A good choice is a responsible member of a local mushing family who is neither running nor handling for the family team.

CHAIN OF COMMAND

- Appointed by the Race Marshall/Chief Judge to whom he is directly responsible.

DUTIES

- Carry out the requests of the Race Marshall/Chief Judge.
- Act as liaison between Race Marshall/Chief Judge and other officials and mushers.

SUGGESTION: Be the person who hands out and collects official's identification, mushers numbers, musher's and handler's armbands

SUGGESTION: Obtain an entry list. Write in actual starting time of each team making adjustments for delayed start, scratched entries, etc. Notify each driver, about ten minutes in advance of his start, of scratches in front of him and how soon his actual start is coming up.

CHIEF TIMER AND CREW

The Timers calculate how much time each team takes to run the course.

CHAIN OF COMMAND

- The Chief Timer is appointed by the Race Giving Organization with the approval of the Race Marshall/Chief Judge. He is responsible to the Race Marshall/ Chief Judge.
- The Chief Timer appoints the Timing Crew, the Finish Marker and the Time Poster, all of whom are responsible to him.

EQUIPMENT

- The timing shack with furnishings is produced by the Properties Custodian and is set up by the Race Site Crew.
- The timing and recording equipment is the responsibility of the timers, whether it belongs to them personally or to someone else.

DUTIES

- Mr. Glenn Boardwell of Anchorage wrote up these jobs in detail for ISDRA at Dr. Lomard's request. His article first appeared in the September 1968 issue of the Alaska Sled Dog Racing News. The entire article is reproduced here.

TIMING MAJOR SLED DOG RACES

PERSONNEL:

Since the Timekeepers are the brain, the heart and the actuating element of the entire operation, they will be discussed first. Just finding personnel with spare time available, and persons willing to devote that time to something of a problem. A good timer or timekeeper must possess certain traits, most important among them being emotional stability, mental acuity, good eyesight and hearing. When these criteria are impressed upon those already mentioned the number of eligible and acceptable to serve as timers and/or timekeepers is drastically reduced.

ENVIRONMENT:

To do accurate and acceptable work, the timing area must be provided with working quarters that assure unrestricted visibility of the start and finish area, adequate protection from interference, a means of communicating with other race officials, at last but not least a minimum degree of personal comfort.

EQUIPMENT:

Timing instruments - Most acceptable from the author's standpoint are standard 23 size, pocket type watches of railroad quality and with sweeping second hand. The "spring and escapement" style of watch has been developed to a remarkable degree of accuracy. Its operation exception of the Accutron that, at the present time, is available only in the wrist model. Electronic watches employing an escapement mechanism are also wrist size and provide little if any advantage over the escapement type watches.

Electric timers, of large watch or clock size, are usually driven by external sources, either 115/230V AC domestic power or by some form of battery, usually 6-12V DC. Any variation in domestic AC power voltage or frequency affects the accuracy of the timing device being fed from this source. There are a number of influences that affect voltage and/or frequency of domestic supply. The most obvious and most effective influence is load, the application of which is uncontrollable. More important of consideration is the possibility of even a momentary complete loss of power. Batteries can supply very even voltage and since the current is DC the difficulty of frequency is eliminated. However, unless attached to a charger, the battery is effected by its environmental conditions like pressure or temperature.

At least three synchronized timepieces should be utilized, and the author frequently utilizes as many as five.

The timing area should have available a good set of binoculars.

Each person should have a clip board large enough to handle the "Time record sheet" He or she should also be provided with a scratch pad and several sharpened pencils for computations.

Previously prepared record and work sheets are a must, and samples of each are included. A public address system with a push to talk "mike" accessible only to the timing crew is highly desirable.

Races of more than 20 miles and/or more than 20 entrants will consume enough time to justify having some refreshment, for instance, a jug of coffee and some sandwiches.

PROCEDURES:

1. Pre Race:

A. Drawing:

The timer and one or more of the timekeepers, along with the secretary of the sponsoring club or association, should be present at the drawing to record the order of start. The presence of the actual operating officials does much to instill confidence in the participants. Though usually a somewhat hurried affair, the timing officials at least see each participant and this is an aid to rapid identification during the race.

If there are any questions in the minds of the participants as to how the race will be tied, they can be cleared up at this time.

B. Scratches:

Once the drawing is over, the timing crew prepares the "Time Record Sheet" Each participant is listed in order of the drawing. No adjustment of the schedule should be permitted. The question of prerace scratches will arise. This situation should be handled as follows: The entrant's name should be lined out all the way across the record sheet and the word "*Scratch*" written across dog and increment columns. The number previously assigned to this entrant will not be issued. For example, No. 11 scratches, No. 12 will follow No. 10 at the regular interval. Late or post entries if permitted will be placed at the end of the schedule and issued the next consecutive number.

B. Two or more heats:

Again, time record sheets should be prepared well before race time showing remaining participants and order of start. These should be checked and double-checked to assure accuracy of transcription.

1. Race:

A. Starting:

The timer should be at the timing work quarters well before race time. Via the P.A. system, he should announce, at intervals, the remaining time before the race starts. The interval between announcements should be shortened as race time approaches so that the interval for the last ten-minute period corresponds to the time interval to be used between teams.

If teams are to leave at two-minute intervals, the announcements should be made at 10, 8, 6, 4, and 2 minutes until race time. All timing personnel should be on hand in the time "shack", no later than 15 minutes before race time.

As a courtesy to other race officials, handlers and spectators it is well for the timer to give an alert followed by a countdown which will permit interested persons to synchronize watches with official time.

Synchronization of all watches in the time shack should be finally checked in the last few minutes before race time and should be spot checked approximately every 30 minutes for the duration of the race.

B. Actual Start:

When the first team is at the starting line, the timer should announce alerts at one minute, 30 seconds, 15 seconds, and 10 seconds until start. The countdown should start at 5, and be sounded 5, 4, 3, 2, 1, Go, with the Go corresponding to zero time. Each contestant should be given identical alerts and countdowns.

The other timing personnel also have certain duties. One should count and announce the number of dogs in the team, and all should record on their sheets. Each of the others should have a stand-by watch in front of him and follow the alerts and countdowns to assure continued synchronization. Any discrepancies observed should be recorded along with exact "clock" time at which the discrepancy was observed. As often as every second or third team, the timer should announce, "John Doe, wearing number XX, will leave at YY minutes". This permits a double check on identity of the musher, his identifying number and his "increment" (See sample record sheet with explanation of columns).

When the last team has left the starting line, if time permits, a complete rundown of all starting data should be read by the timer and checked by all remaining personnel on duty.

At this point the time record sheets should have data tabulated in the following order: Column one: number worn by musher. Column two: musher's name. Column three: number of dogs in the team. Column four: blank. Column five: a two or three digit number. This letter number is the increment and represents the amount to be subtracted from finish time to determine elapsed time.

EXAMPLE

Column 1 (number)	2 (name)	3 (no. Of dogs)	4 (carried)	5 (increment)
1	John Doe	12		00
2	Jane Fox	9		02
3	Don Lee	14		04
4	Jim Fish	11		06
5	Joe Blow	16		08

Etc.

Even though starting tie is 1:00 PM or 1:15 PM, or any other clock time, the watches should be set and synchronized to start with the hands at 12:00 hours. Once the race is started, clock time is of no interest to the timing crew. Only elapsed time concerns them. The following details are the heart and soul of this operation and should be religiously adhered to.

C. The Finish:

Determination of the minutes within the first hour, 12:00 to 1:00 are read direct. All times are to be read directly in minutes. Therefore an event to be timed when the watch shows 1:05 should be recorded at 65 minutes. Now since the watches were synchronized to show 12:00 at the start of the race, the hour hand will indicate the number of 60-minute increments that have elapsed since the start of the race. This provides a quick check on the accuracy with which the timer has carried forward his minutes. Example: A musher crosses the line at the time the watch shows 2:21 plus seconds. The call should be 141 minutes, because 2 times 60 plus 21 equals 141 minutes. Each person with a stand-by watch before him should verify the finish time call and, if in agreement, all should record in Column 6, "141 minutes". If this musher has recorded under his increment Column 5 digits "12", his elapsed time is derived by straight arithmetical subtraction. 141 minus 12, equals 129 minutes. This 129 should be recorded in Column 7. The timer should make every effort to call the minutes in which the contestant will complete. At about 15 seconds before the contestant crosses the finish line the timer should start his count and establish the correct rhythm. This count will be in exact accordance with the second's hand movement around the face of the watch for example: 25, 26, 27, and 28.... 40, 41, etc. All personnel except the timer have eyes focused on the finish judge, who drops his hand at the instant the finish occurs. Each record the last "second" called they heard before the hand fell. The timer should continue his count until stopped with a predetermined signal from one of his timing personnel. The significant digit i.e., the one (1) in the count "forty-one" should be accented and barked like a drill sergeant's command on the exact instant the second hand crosses the point on the watch face. Assuming 41 is the

recorded second count, the figures in Column 6 would now be 141:41 and the figures on Column 7 would now be 129:41.

TRAIL BOSS

The Trail Boss is responsible for the layout and condition of the trail.

QUALIFICATIONS

- Must be dependable.
- Must be available before, during and after the race
- Must be familiar with the area.
- Should have sled dog racing experience.

CHAIN OF COMMAND

- Appointed by the Race Giving Organization with the approval of the Race Marshall/Chief Judge.
- Responsible to the Race Marshall/Chief Judge.

EQUIPMENT

- Trail packing machines and crews to man them.
- Trail Markers

DUTIES

- Be familiar with those race rules pertaining to the course. (See Race Manual EE-1, FF-1, Rules IA 2, 3, 4)
- Plan and lay out the trail subject to the approval of the Race Marshall/Chief Judge. (See Race Manual Section P)
- Pack trail. (See Race Manual Section R)
 - Obtain trail packing machines and crews
 - Plan and direct their operations.
- Mark Trail (See Race Manual Section Q, EE-1, FF-1, Rule I A 1)
 - Markers are made by the Race Committee and stored by the Properties Custodian. (See Sign Painter and Properties Custodian, this handbook)
 - Determine where Trail Checkers, Trail Stewards and Radio Operators should be located.
 - Determine where local or state police are needed to direct traffic at major road crossings.
 - Trail Stewards should always be stationed with police at major road crossings to assist teams. The Race Marshall/Chief Judge must approve all positions.
 - Provide transport for all trail personnel to and from stations as requested.
 - Provide transport for official photographers and radio operators as necessary.
 - Maintain the trail between heats.

- With your crew, check entire trail before and after each heat. Check to see that all markers are in place.
 - Repack, drag, repair bad spots, and replace markers as necessary.
 - Report to the Race Marshall/Chief Judge immediately of any newly developed hazards, which may delay the start of the race or causing the complete cancellation of the race. (See Race Manual HH-2, ZZ-1)
-
- Pick up markers after the race and return to Properties Custodian.

TRAIL CHECKER

Trail Checkers watch for and check off on the list all teams as they pass on the trail.

CHAIN OF COMMAND

- Appointed by and responsible to the Trail Judge

BEFORE YOU GO OUT

- Read all written instructions provided by the Trail Judge.
- The Trail Judge will tell you which station you are assigned to and will arrange transportation if necessary.
- Be sure you understand where you will be and which way the teams should be going for all classes you are checking.
- Ask any questions of the Trail Judge before you take up your position.

EQUIPMENT

- Clothing suitable to provide protection from prolonged exposure to the weather.
 - Official's identification.
- Written instructions and checklist.
- Several sharp pencil and watch.
- Long leash or length of rope suitable to tie a possible loose team or dog.
- Good and thermos, if necessary.

HOW TO DO YOUR JOB

- Team approaches on the trail:
 - Watch the list to have an idea of which team it may be. Identify the team by the number the driver is wearing. If you miss the one of this chest, he has another on his back. Stand quietly. Be visible to the driver but far enough off the trail so as not to disturb the dogs. Do not speak to the driver unless necessary or he asks you a question.
- Timing.
 - Note the time to the nearest minute that the team passed. Record it on the checklist, this time is not official. The drivers may wish to know their times at different points, or in case of some confusion on the trail, the Race Marshall/Chief Judge may refer to them.
- Two Classes:
 - Be alert for when one class ends and the next one starts. Record it on the checklist, this is not official. He may have turned around and gone back. So do not assume that all teams of the first class will pass before the second one starts to come along.

- Do not identify teams by the number of dogs they have. Teams in two classes can be running the same number. Identify by the driver's number only. At the start of a new class or if two classes become mixed up, it is safest to ask each driver which class he is in.
- Unusual Happenings:
 - Note on your checklist any unusual happenings you observe: loose team or dog, team on wrong trail or going the wrong way, team missing, driver not wearing number, etc. Particularly not any physical abuse of a dog. A driver may not hit a dog with a whip or anything else. Turn your checklist into the Trail Judge on your return. Point out to him any unusual happenings you have noted. Stay available at the race site for a while to see if the Race Marshall/Chief Judge wishes to ask you about times or anything else that happened on the trail.

TRAIL CHECKERS REPORT FORM

RACE NAME _____

RACE DATE _____

HEAT _____

CHECKER _____

POSITION _____

.....

CLASS _____ START TIME _____

Number	Name	Passed	Time	Remarks
1.	_____	_____	_____	_____
2.	_____	_____	_____	_____
3.	_____	_____	_____	_____
4.	_____	_____	_____	_____
5.	_____	_____	_____	_____

Include enough space to cover all teams in the concerened class.

CLASS _____ START TIME _____

Number	Name	Passed	Time	Remarks
1.	_____	_____	_____	_____
2.	_____	_____	_____	_____
3.	_____	_____	_____	_____
4.	_____	_____	_____	_____
5.	_____	_____	_____	_____
6.	_____	_____	_____	_____
7.	_____	_____	_____	_____
8.	_____	_____	_____	_____
9.	_____	_____	_____	_____
10.	_____	_____	_____	_____

TRAIL JUDGE

The Trail Judge is in charge of all Trail Checkers, Trail Stewards and Observers.

QUALIFICATIONS

- Should be knowledgeable of sled dog racing.
- Have no personal interest in any team racing

CHAIN OF COMMAND

- Appointed by and responsible to the Race Marshall/Chief Judge

EQUIPMENT

- Sets of written instructions.
- Extra leashes, ropes, and pencils for trail personnel as necessary.

DUTIES

- Appointed enough Trail Checkers and Trail Stewards to man stations set up by the Trail Boss and approved by the Race Marshal/Chief Judge.
- Assign each person to his individual station.
- Prepare individual sets of written instructions. (Request copies from the Race Committee Secretary as necessary.) Include:
 - One copy "Trail Checker" or "Trail Steward" job description.
 - One copy "How to Assist Teams on the Trail"
 - Map of trail showing direction of race for each class and stations of trail personnel.
 - For Trail Checkers include also a checklist of contestants. Make up a new one for each heat. (See blank from this handbook)
- Distribute written instructions to trail personnel and answer any questions they may have.
- Get authorization from Race Marshall/chief Judge for verbal instructions to individual Trail Stewards.
- Give each Trail Steward his own verbal instructions.
- In addition to the Trail Checkers and Trail Stewards, it may be necessary to station additional personnel as Observers at points along the trail where rule violations are possible. Appoint such personnel as necessary and instruct to make notes of any unusual happenings. (Like trail cutting)
- See that all trail personnel have necessary supplies.
- See that all trail personnel have transport to and from their stations. Request transport from Trail Boss, if necessary.
- After the race, collect checklist and hand them in to the Race Marshall/Chief Judge.

- Call to the attention of the Race Marshall/Chief Judge any unusual happenings, which have been noted on the checklists or reported by the Trail Steward or observers.

TRAIL STEWARD

- Trail Stewards are those people who carry out the rule "All teams may receive similar assistance of any kind of officials stationed at designated points along the trail if so authorized by the Race Marshall/Chief Judge. (See Race Manual EE-5, Rule III D 1)
- Examples of when Trail Stewards may be authorized. Trail crosses major road, junction of trails confusing to the lead dog, steep hill, trail re-routed at last moment or second heat, bridge out, turn-around for junior classes, etc.

QUALIFICATIONS

- Physically capable of carrying out assigned duty.
- Knowledge of dogs.

CHAIN OF COMMAND

- Appointed by and responsible to the Trail Judge.

EQUIPMENT

- Clothing suitable for protection from prolonged exposure to the weather.
- Official's identification.
- Written instructions provided by Trail Judge
- Long leash or length of rope suitable for tying possible loose team or dog.
- Length of rope suitable for keeping back spectators if necessary.

DUTIES

- The Trail Judge will assign your station. He will arrange transport to and from it, if necessary.
- The Trail Judge will give verbal instructions authorized by the Race Marshall/Chief Judge to you.
- These instructions may authorize you to hold dogs or lines, guide lead dogs by their harnesses, police spectators, or anything else. The purpose of your assistance is the safety and well being of the dogs and drivers.
- Note any unusual happenings that you observe: loose teams, team on the wrong trail, team going the wrong way, etc. Particularly not any physical abuse of a dog. A driver may not hit a dog with a whip or anything else.
- Report verbally to the Trail Judge after the race any unusual happenings.

- Stay available at the race site for a while after the race to see if the Race Marshall/Chief Judge wishes to ask you about anything that took place on the trail.

DOG MARKING JUDGES

Two or more officials to mark dogs for identification.

CHAIN OF COMMAND

- Appointed by the Chief Judge/Race Marshall and responsible to him.

DUTIES

- Inform entrants of time and place for marking dogs
- Obtain dog marking and recording materials.
- Mark dogs well before the race
- Record number of dogs marked for each team.
- If dogs are marked differently, record type used on each dog.
- Recheck for markings after dogs are hitched in the team but before they are in the chute. If all dogs are marked the same, the Inspection Judge can do the checking.
- Record actual number of dogs leaving with the team.
 - Check against number recorded for that team.
 - Note any dogs dropped in the chute
 - Negate marking on any dog not used.
- When teams come in, check number and markings of dogs. Record that all dogs starting on a team have returned.

SECOND HEAT

- Recheck markings and record number of dogs leaving on each team.
- Check number and markings of dogs returning on each team.
- Report any discrepancies to the Chief Judge/Race Marshall.

INSPECTION JUDGES

One or more officials to pass on the legality and soundness of equipment and dogs.

QUALIFICATIONS

- Knowledge of the race rules
- Knowledge of sled dogs

CHAIN OF COMMAND

- Appointed by the Chief Judge/Race Marshall and responsible to him.

DUTIES

- Inspect all dogs and equipment by their trucks well before the start of the race to allow the driver time to make changes.
- The Veterinarian should be consulted in case of a questionable dog.
- If the condition of the driver makes his ability to complete the course questionable, advise the Chief Judge/Race Marshall immediately.
- Recheck all teams quickly in the line-up to see that no illegal additions or substitutions have been made.
 - You should be able to inspect teams - if they have been in the line-up a reasonable length of time - well before they enter the chute.
 - Dogs hitched into a team should not be subjected to unnecessary handling by strangers.
 - Only under most unusual circumstances should it be necessary to inspect a team already in the chute.
- Report anything unusual to the Chief Judge/Race Marshall

VETERINARIAN

Consultant: Corey Cherrstrom D. V. M.

CHAIN OF COMMAND

- Services arranged for by the Race Marshall/Chief Judge who is responsible for him.

DUTIES

Please:

- Be available in the starting area well before the start of the race to examine any dog on request of an official. Advise the Chief Judge/Race Marshall as to its fitness to run the race.
- On request of the Chief Judge/Race Marshall, examine dogs brought back in the sled basket.
- Have equipment and supplies on hand to treat emergencies.
 - Example: shock, lacerations, fractures.
- When drug testing is to be done, supervise collection of samples. The Chief Judge/Race Marshall will provide you with a copy of "ISDRA Drug Control Procedure."

THANK YOU FOR YOUR HELP!

Saying "THANK YOU!"

Although this final section of the Official's handbook has nothing to do with officiating pre se, it can be important to regards to the availability of competent officials for future races. Too often, after the last hurrah has been sounded for the contestants, the volunteer worker is left to go home without so much as a pat on the back or even a little thank you. When next year's race rolls around, these same people - these same experienced people - are not quite so enthusiastic about going out on the trail and freezing to death.

Clubs have solved this problem through various means. A few methods are: individual letters emanating for the club through the secretary's office. Free passes to social functions run in conjunction with the sled dog race, formal recognition through the public news media of the area, certificates of recognition, banquets or socials arranged specifically for the volunteer workers with others paying their own way, etc., etc.

Most workers volunteer because of a desire to be a part of the rave. It takes very little to maintain this motivation. A sincere form of thanks is usually effective, and the appreciation of the recipient is reflected in his continued willingness to serve your organization.

CLOTHING, REFRESHMENTS AND RECORDING EQUIPMENT

When an official has to be outside for several hours with no protection from the elements, clothing becomes of primary importance. Footwear should be given detailed consideration. It should be loose and have plenty of insulation. Make sure socks start out completely dry. Try to keep them dry.

Have more outer clothing than you need rather than less. You can always peel off the excess. In case of wet snow or rain, have a waterproof covering. Make sure inner clothing stays dry, both from the outside and from perspiration. Keep gloves dry or change them.

A small pack which includes extra gloves or mitten liners, a face mask, hand warmer, etc., can be of great value in low temperatures and especially when a strong wind brings a chill factor. In that same pack a thermos of hot coffee, tea or chocolate can be a lifesaver.

For those confined to warm but limited space, keep outside wearing apparel to a minimum. This allows for maneuverability and prevents perspiring. It is especially pertinent to officials operating with in an automobile.

Officials with any writing duties should have available an extra supply of sharpened pencils, erasers are on the end of a pencil for a reason. Besides, pens do not function well in cold or wet conditions. They usually either freeze completely or the ink smears. Scratch pads are useful in many different ways. Clipboards make a good writing base.